

Enterprise readiness and structure comparison

Rubric 0–5 with written evidence · Helper vs loaders and peer addons

This pack is a snapshot, not a ranking contest. Numbers are GitHub asset download counts on the latest listed release unless noted. Those counts are not unique users: Nexus auto-update re-downloads the DLL; CEF/catalog zips count first helper opens more than daily actives. Closed-source addons without a public release API are listed without download figures. No single score is used. Hyperbole from earlier canvases in this workspace is not reused.

Enterprise in this document does not mean SOC 2, a support SLA, or a company. It means: would a cautious guild or a studio IT-minded player accept this binary next to a live MMO client? Scores are integers 0–5. Averages are shown as x/5, not as percentages. Earlier workspace canvases that put Helper near 89% are not used; team size and user base were over-weighted there.

1. Rubric

ID	Criterion	0	5
E1	Host isolation	Present hook or writes into game CEF	Separate process, no Present, documented IPC
E2	Game-memory / input policy	Undocumented scrapers, gameplay SendInput	Written forbid-list; no memory R/W; input exceptions explicit and off by default
E3	Secrets	Keys on a server or in git	No remote keys; at-rest protection; CI keyless
E4	CI / tests	None	Multi-compiler, integration, fuzzed IPC
E5	Documentation	Readme only	Normative compliance + architecture + security contact
E6	Supply chain	Unsigned mystery DLL from Discord	Signed binaries, hashed runtimes, reproducible build
E7	Bus factor / process	One person, no issues, dirty tree	Multiple maintainers, review, release trains
E8	Attack surface vs job	Browser+scripts for a timer	Surface matches the stated job
E9	Structure / modularity	Few giant files, no boundaries	Domain split, size cap, kernel called out
E10	Operational proof	New / tiny user base	Years + large install base surviving patches

2. Helper scores (tree 2.3.0.0 / HEAD 568b8cd)

ID	Score	Evidence
E1 Isolation	4	OOP CEF, Job Object KILL_ON_JOB_CLOSE, PID-scoped maps, current-user DACL with Win32 fallback. DLL still in GW2.exe. Software OSR, no-sandbox.
E2 Memory/input	4	COMPLIANCE.md forbid-list is specific. MumbleLink display-only. Map assist SendInput is opt-in and scoped to world map — that caps this at 4, not 5.
E3 Secrets	3	Keys only in local settings.ini; CI must not use live keys; SECURITY.md. Ini is plaintext. No remote key store (good) and no DPAPI (gap).
E4 CI	3	make ci: stamps, sites schema, CSS test, parse goldens, IPC smoke, JsonView, MinGW build. No MSVC, no CEF launch, no GW2.
E5 Docs	4	ARCHITECTURE (291 lines), COMPLIANCE, SECURITY, WHITEPAPER (1024), CATALOG_RELEASE, API_KEY, PUBLISHER_ACCESS. Unusual for a GW2 addon. Some companion files named in ARCHITECTURE were not present as docs/MODULES.md etc. in the glob this run.
E6 Supply chain	2	SHA-256 for CEF and EI zips. GitHub Releases. Unsigned MinGW. Defender note in COMPLIANCE.md. Catalog on a mutable pre-release tag — convenience vs immutability trade.
E7 Bus factor	1	Created 2026-07-19, 2 stars, 0 open issues, one GitHub org. Dirty working tree on master at review time. No public multi-maintainer evidence.

ID	Score	Evidence
E8 Attack surface	2	Job is a wiki/API companion, so CEF is justified, but it is still full Chromium + BootJs + ad routes + no-sandbox. Larger than every focused Nexus dll in the compare set.
E9 Structure	4	Domain folders, ≤500 guideline, kernel table, IPC schema discipline, catalog vs DLL split. Six files over 500 lines. Dual ImGui/HTML increases coordination cost.
E10 Proof	1	Latest DLL 585; CEF zip 249 historical. Not patch-proven across a GW2 expansion cycle.

Average: $28/50 = 2.8/5$. Read as: strong written policy and above-average structure for its age; weak operational proof, signing, and staffing. Not “enterprise ready” in the IT sense.

3. Peer scores (same rubric, coarser because internals are less visible)

Peers are scored from public behavior, GitHub releases, and common architecture knowledge. Closed source (ArcDPS) gets wide intervals implicitly: we score the *observable* model. These are not precise to a tenth.

Product	E1	E2	E3	E4	E5	E6	E7	E8	E9	E10	Sum/50
Blish HUD	5	4	4	4	4	3	4	3	5	5	41
Nexus	2	3	3	3	3	3	4	3	3	4	31
GW2Radial	2	3	3	3	3	3	3	5	4	5	34
Commander's Toolkit	3	3	3	2	2	3	3	5	3	4	31
Boon Table	1	2	3	2	2	2	3	4	3	4	26
Helper (this tree)	4	4	3	3	4	2	1	2	4	1	28
Tyrian Codex	3	3	3	1	2	2	2	3	3	1	23
Discordant	3	3	3	1	2	2	1	2	2	1	20
Map Completion / TWC	3	3	3	2	2	2	2	5	4	3	29
ArcDPS	1	1	2	1	1	2	3	2	?	5	~20
TacO (legacy viewer)	2	3	3	1	2	2	2	4	3	5	27

ArcDPS E9 is unknown (limited public tree). E10 is 5 on usage. Sum ~20 is isolation/policy dragging a must-install tool. That is the point of not collapsing “safe” and “useful.”

4. How to read the table

- Blish leads this rubric because of process isolation, module structure, docs/SDK, and years of users — not because it has a CEF wiki.
- Radial scores well because surface matches job (E8=5) and E10=5. Helper cannot match that while shipping Chromium.
- Helper beats Codex/Discordant on docs, CI, and isolation writeup. It does not beat Blish, and it does not beat Radial on operational proof.
- Nexus as host cannot score 5 on E1: it is the d3d11.dll. Addons that avoid their own Present hook are still one host bug away from a black screen.
- ArcDPS last on this rubric and first on raid necessity. Do not average List A with this table.

5. Structure comparison

Product	Shape	Extension model	Content vs code
Helper	Monolithic Nexus DLL + extracted helper EXE + private CEF dir + IPC kernel. Domain folders under src/. Dual UI (ImGui pads + generated HTML).	No third-party module API. Sites.json and .taco packs are data. PathingLua is opt-in pack scripts.	Code-heavy (~92k). Art/names moved to GitHub IGH + CEF zip so the DLL stay ~19 MB.

Product	Shape	Extension model	Content vs code
Blish HUD	Standalone C# overlay process. Modules as separate packages.	First-class module SDK. This is the structural opposite of Helper's monolith.	Code in modules; pathing packs as data.
Nexus	Host DLL + addons/*.dll	C/C++ addon ABI (Nexus API). Helper is one such addon.	Host is code; content lives in addons.
Tyrian Codex	Nexus DLL + many named .pack / .tcpk on GitHub Releases.	Not a general module host. Content updates are pack files.	Content-heavy (hundreds of MB). DLL 6.3 MB.
ArcDPS	Injected meter + plugin DLLs (boon table, etc.).	ArcDPS plugin ABI. Boon Table is a plugin, not a Nexus addon.	Code. Encounter logic is the asset.
GW2Radial / CTK / TWC	Single small DLL or zip.	None. Change requests go to the author.	Code-only, small.
TacO / pathing	Viewer + .taco XML/zip packs from many authors.	Open pack format. Viewers compete; packs reuse.	Content-heavy. Helper participates as a viewer.

6. Helper structural strengths and costs

Strengths visible in tree

- Kernel called out (entry*, WikiBrowser*, WikiIpc.h) with schema bump rules and test-ipc.
- Feature domains map to pads (account, pathing, logs, ...) instead of one UI_*.cpp.
- Catalog/CEF kept off the shipping DLL tag — correct split for update size.
- Stamps (.ver) for helper/home/sites/cheatsheets/live/ui-chrome/watchd to force re-extract.
- ApiBudget global cap rather than unbounded thread storms (API Check was also reduced to 5 sequential canaries on HEAD).

Costs

- Monolith: a wallet fetch bug and a CEF nav bug share one DLL release.
- Two UI toolkits (ImGui + HTML/CSS with downlevel tests) doubles the presentation stack.
- no-sandbox + software OSR is a compatibility choice with a security cost (E1/E8).
- Uncommitted log-manager/catalog work on master at review time — process score (E7) stays 1 until releases match the tree and review is visible.
- ≤500 line rule is social, not enforced in CI (6 files over; 63 over 400).

7. Enterprise readiness statement

A cautious org should treat Helper like any unsigned, single-maintainer Nexus addon that embeds Chromium: optional, hash-pin the CEF zip, do not paste API keys into screenshots, prefer full GW2 restart after DLL replace, and do not expect a support contract. The written compliance surface is better than most GW2 addons of this age. That is not the same as ready for managed-enterprise deployment.

If the question is “is the repo structured like a product rather than a paste?” — yes, more than Codex/Discordant in this pull, less than Blish's module OS. If the question is “should a raid static standardize on it?” — not yet; List A still ends before Helper.

8. Method limits

- No source audit of ArcDPS, Nexus internals, or Codex beyond public releases.
- GitHub downloads omit Raidcore's in-app installer, Discord mirrors, and Nexus auto-update uniqueness.
- LOC is not quality. Helper's 92k lines include generated/embed headers.
- Scores will change when 2.3.0.0 ships, if Authenticode is added, or if sandboxing ships.
- This review used the local dirty tree; players on 2.2.4.11 do not have all HEAD behavior (catalog, 5-probe API Check, log-manager edits).